# Heat Gun



Category: **Power Tools & Workshop Machines** Type: **Full SOP** Priority: **High** 2 labs

**Covers these lab items:** Heat Gun; Heat Gun/Torch

## What it is used for

A heat gun produces a controlled stream of hot air for tasks such as paint softening, heat-shrink work, and material forming. Use the correct temperature and nozzle for the material and keep the hot airflow away from people and combustible items.

## Main parts

- Heat-resistant gun body and handle
- Heating element and air outlet
- Temperature and airflow controls
- Power switch and power cord
- Interchangeable nozzle attachments, if supplied
- Stand or heat-resistant resting support

## Before you start

1. Read the instructions and confirm that the heat gun suits the intended task.
2. Inspect the cord, plug, casing, air inlet, and nozzle for damage.
3. Clear the work area of flammable materials, liquids, and unnecessary clutter.
4. Select a nozzle and temperature suitable for the material.
5. Wear safety glasses and heat-resistant gloves where appropriate.
6. Ensure adequate ventilation, especially when heating coatings, plastics, or adhesives.

## How to use

1. Place the material on a stable, heat-resistant work surface.
2. Fit the correct nozzle while the gun is switched off and cool.
3. Connect the plug to a suitable electrical outlet.
4. Switch on the heat gun and select a low suitable temperature setting.
5. Allow the tool to warm up according to the manufacturer's instructions.
6. Keep the nozzle at the recommended distance from the workpiece.
7. Move the hot airflow continuously unless the task instructions require otherwise.
8. Monitor the material for softening, shrinking, or other expected changes.
9. Reduce heat or stop if the material discolours, smokes, bubbles, or burns.
10. Switch off the tool after completing the task.
11. Place the tool on its designated heat-resistant stand while it cools.
12. Unplug the tool after use and allow it to cool completely before storage.
13. Inspect the work area for hot surfaces or smouldering material.

## ⚠ Safety

- Never direct hot air at people, animals, skin, or clothing.
- Do not use near flammable vapours, fuel, or explosive atmospheres.
- Keep the air inlet and outlet clear during operation.
- Avoid touching the nozzle or recently heated material; severe burns can occur.
- Do not leave the tool operating unattended.
- Disconnect power before changing accessories or performing maintenance.

## Care & storage

- Allow the tool to cool completely before cleaning.
- Keep the air inlet and outlet free from dust and debris.
- Inspect the power cord, casing, and nozzle attachments regularly.
- Store the heat gun in a dry place away from combustible materials.
- Remove damaged tools from service and arrange authorised repair.

## Common mistakes to avoid

- Holding the hot airflow too close to the material.
- Using excessive temperature and damaging the workpiece.
- Placing the hot tool on an unsuitable surface.
- Leaving the tool plugged in or unattended while hot.

*Disclaimer: This SOP is prepared from general information available on the internet. For detailed instructions, refer to the manufacturer's original manual / file.*